

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

Behind the Fire

An Anger Release Journal



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · own it, release it

WELCOME

Before You Begin



Anger gets a bad reputation, but here's the truth:
anger is information. It's the smoke alarm, not the fire.
Something matters, something got crossed, something hurts.

This journal stands on one strong idea: your feelings
are YOURS. People can strike the match, but the fire
burns in your house — which means you hold the hose.
That's not blame. That's power.

These pages will let you rage safely, find what's really
burning underneath, and choose your response on purpose
instead of letting the fire choose for you.

What's Burning



PART ONE

What Lit It



*Before you can put a fire out, you have to look
straight at it.*

What sets you off fastest? List your matches — the comments, behaviors, and situations that light you instantly.



What does your anger look like when it wins — the words, the volume, the shutdown, the slammed doors? Describe it honestly.



Whose anger did you grow up watching? What did it teach you anger is for?



What's the anger you keep re-feeling — the old one that reheats itself over and over? Tell its story.



*What has your anger cost you so far —
relationships, peace, sleep, moments you can't take
back?*



When has your anger been RIGHT — a boundary crossed, an injustice real? Anger isn't always the villain. Honor those times.



PART TWO

Behind the Fire



*Anger is almost never the first feeling. It's the
bodyguard for a softer one.*

Pick your most recent blowup or slow burn. What happened five seconds BEFORE the anger — what did you feel first?



What's usually hiding behind your fire — hurt, fear, embarrassment, feeling unseen or disrespected?



Complete this for your biggest current anger: 'I'm angry because... and underneath that, I'm really feeling...'



*Whose behavior are you waiting on to feel better —
and how long has that wait lasted so far?*



Here's the hard one: nobody can make you feel anything without your nervous system's cooperation. Where do you have more ownership of your reactions than you've been claiming?



*What does your anger need you to actually DO —
set a boundary, grieve something, say a hard truth,
walk away?*



PART THREE

Choosing the Response



*Between the match and the explosion, there's
a gap. This section lives in the gap.*

What are your body's earliest anger signals — heat, tight jaw, fast heart? Learn your smoke alarm.



What's your gap plan — the thing you'll do in the ten seconds between trigger and reaction? Design it.



*What healthy releases actually empty your fire —
writing here, hard exercise, loud music, cold air?
Build your release list.*



What conversation does your anger keep demanding? Draft the calm version here — the one that gets heard.



What are you ready to release for YOUR sake — not because they deserve it, but because carrying fire burns the carrier?



Write your new anger rules: what you'll feel fully, what you'll never do again, and how you'll release instead. Sign it.



For the Boiling Moments



When the fire's rising, thinking shrinks. Check your moves now, use them then.

- ☐ Ten-second gap: breathe out slow before one word leaves
- ☐ Leave the room legally: 'I need a minute, I'll be back'
- ☐ Cold water on hands or face — real fire, real water
- ☐ Move hard for two minutes: walk fast, push a wall, shake it out
- ☐ Write the rage here instead of texting it
- ☐ Say the underneath feeling out loud: 'I'm actually hurt'
- ☐ Lower my voice one notch below theirs
- ☐ Delay the verdict: 'I'll respond to this tomorrow'
- ☐ Ask myself: will this matter in a month? A year?
- ☐ Return and repair when cool — that's strength, not weakness

BONUS · KEEP THIS PAGE

Fires I Put Out Myself



Every time you felt the heat and chose your response anyway — log it. This page is proof of who's really in charge now.

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BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



Your anger was never the problem. Unexamined anger was.
And you just examined yours with more honesty than
most people ever will.

Remember the power in the hard truth: nobody else
runs your internal weather. Matches will keep coming —
people will be people — but the fire is yours,
the hose is yours, and the response is yours.

That's not a burden. That's freedom.



*They can strike the match. You decide
what burns.*



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